

5.2 Will It Be The CD Or The DVD?

Every computer, old or new, is equipped with an optical drive. While CD-ROM drives were the norm on older computers, newer ones are provided with CD-RW or CD-RW/DVD combo drives. The arrival of the CD was a turning point in the history of computing, as one could now store 500 times more data on a CD than on a floppy disk, thus saving cost—coupled with the added benefit of portability.

CDs could be relied on for data integrity (being a write-once medium), and you could be positive that the data present on the disc would not be damaged unless you wanted it to be.

With falling prices, CD-RW drives have now become common. In fact, a CD-RW drive costs as much as a CD-ROM drive did about two years ago. With a CD-RW drive, home users have found a new way to store data and free their hard drive from files that need not be perpetually available on the computer but may be needed in the future.



A single format DVD Writer

CD-RW drives are available for as low as Rs 1.5K, and offer an extremely cheap storage option, which is unrivalled by any other device till date. CD-RW drives are available in internal and external forms, with internal CD burners being cheaper. An external CD-RW offer portability—as you can carry it around rather than having it fixed in a machine. However, the cost difference is a deterrent, and users would prefer the internal version.